

SKITCH & GRIP

BOODLE

EPISODE 09 –
ARRIVAL





Out here, the sea
has rules ol' maps
don't tell ye.

Some'll keep ye
alive. Others just
keep ye humble.

Best learn 'em
before she does.



Never whistle
on open water.

Calls the wind
like a dog to a
blood trail.

Never name
a storm.

Gives it an ear
it might not
have had.

GRIP'S NOTES:
Wind = attention.
Storm = ego?
File under: Maybe Both.



Right... superstition
or seamanship?



Ooh!
Biscuit!



The wake's like
sparkles!



That gull. Same distance.
Every time.



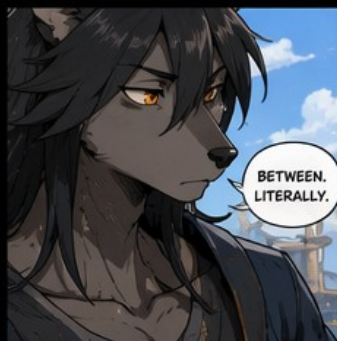
Asked what
they're for.
He said,
"Reasons
aren't for
every deck."

Filed under:
Not Your
Business.

The sea don't care
what ye believe.

But she does notice
what ye do.





THE TIDELINE LEGACY

Three Generations.
Two Hundred Tall Tales.
One Half-Sunk Boat.

TIDELINE

CHANDLERY • KITCHEN
REPAIRS • LODGING

TODAY'S SPECIAL:
GRANDMA'S FISH STEW
+ EXAGGERATION

TIDELINE FOUNDING 1997

MAREK TIDELINE SHIPWEIGHT

A. TIDELINE NETS & NAUTICALS

OUR ROOF SURVIVED THREE HURRICANES AND A TIDAL WAVE.

...AND A SEA MONSTER.

M+L 1997 A.T. 2001 R&T 2004 JOK 2010 E.T. 2017

NOT A TIDAL WAVE, DEAR. A STORM SURGE. BIG DIFFERENCE.

IT WAS A STORM SURGE RIDING A ROGUE WAVE PUSHED BY A BLOOD MOON TIDE WHILE THE SEA MONSTER DISTRACTED THE LIGHTHOUSE.

ACTUALLY, COUSIN SAYS THE LIGHTHOUSE WAS THEIR IDEA. THEY LURED IT.

WHICH PART IS TRUE?! THIS MATTERS! HISTORY MATTERS! ...TO SOMEONE?

MMM! DRIED MANGO.

OH, AND THE SEA MONSTER? IT WASN'T EVEN REAL. IT WAS MY GREAT-UNCLE WEARING A BARREL.

CLATTER!
CLATTER!
CLATTER!

HE WAS WEARING TWO BARRELS. VERY IMPORTANT DETAIL.

COUSIN ALSO SAYS GREAT-UNCLE DID IT TO IMPRESS GREAT-AUNT WHO STOLE HIS LUNCH. IT WAS LOVE.

OR PRIDE. OR BOTH.

DOCUMENTS? LOGBOOKS? EYEWITNESS ACCOUNTS? ANYTHING BESIDES VIBES AND VINTAGE BRAGGING?!

THEY CORRECT EACH OTHER. THEY SHARE. THEY SNACK. I LIKE THIS FAMILY! VERY TRUSTWORTHY!

10/10 WOULD BOODLE AGAIN! ❤️



NANA TIDE

Net Weaver.
Truth Keeper.
Story Corrector.
(Every third sentence.)



MAREK TIDELINE

Dock Handler.
Tall Tale Dealer.
Exaggerates Professionally.



KIP TIDELINE

Cousin. Listener.
Contradicts Quietly.
Collects Trinkets.
Knows Things.



SKITCH

Curious.
Seeks Facts.
Ears Glow When Confused.



GRIP

Researcher.
Seeks Accuracy.
Rarely Heard.
Often Frustrated.



BOODLE

Listener.
Snack Enthusiast.
Judges Quickly.
Very Caring.

TIDEWALKER MARKET MIDDAY BREEZE

WHERE VALUE
ISN'T COUNTED—
IT'S CARRIED.

I'LL PAY
DOUBLE. TRIPLE.
NAME IT.

THIS ROPE—
HOW MUCH?

NOT FOR
MONEY,
GRIP.

THIS ROPE IS
TRADED—THROUGH
TRUST, THROUGH
USEFULNESS.

YOU PROVE
YOU'LL STRENGTHEN
THE WEB, AND THE WEB
WILL STRENGTHEN
YOU.

COIN WEIGHS
THE HAND.
TRUST WEIGHS
THE HEART.

FAVOR-
TRADING
VENDOR

Rope • Salt •
Lanterns • Fruit
Baskets • Hooks
Herbs • Shells
Maps • Knives
Stories...

AND
FAVORS.

GOODS LEFT,
GOODS RETURNED.
NO RECEIPTS.

A KNIFE BORROWED
WITHOUT ASKING.

MESSAGES MOVE
ON SMALL FEET.

THE INTERIOR BELL
RINGS WITH
INTERIOR WIND.

SCRAPS FOR THE
ONE WHO WAITS.

GRIP'S COMPARATIVE
CHART OF ROPE GRADES.

ROPE GRADES: STRENGTH & USE

GRADE	MATERIAL	TENSILE STRENGTH	FLEX RATING	SALT RESISTANCE	BEST USE	NOTES
1	HEMP TWIST	1X	C	C	GENERAL USE (LOW LOAD)	
2	PALM FIBER	1.7X	B-	C	RIGGING, BINDING	
3	SEA GRASS	2.2X	B	B-	MOORING, NETS	
4	BRAIDED SINEW	3.1X	B+	B	LOAD-BEARING	
5	TIDEWALKER CORD	5.6X	A	A+	CRUCIAL LINES	

♥ TIDEWALKER CORD: SALT-CRADLED, MULTI-BRAID, CURED IN SHADE & SPRAY.

WHOOOSH!

THE WIND FLIPS
THE PAGE.

For Rell:
- Smokefruit (2)
- Saltcakes (3)
- Gingerleaf tea
(No shell bits!)

For Ma:
- River Greens
- Grilled Mullet
- Extra Chili

TWO LUNCH ORDERS
FILL THE BACK.

IT'S STRONGER
THAN ANY ROPE
I'VE TESTED.
STRONGER
BY FAR.

SURELY THAT
COUNTS FOR
SOMETHING.

IT COUNTS.
IT COUNTS A LOT.

BUT STRENGTH
ISN'T HOARDED
HERE.

IT'S CARED FOR.
SHARED.

RETURNED.

COME BACK
USEFUL.

THE ROPE WILL
KNOW WHEN
YOU ARE.

AND SO
WILL WE.

THAT'S HOW
TIDEWALKER MARKET
HOLDS TOGETHER.



FAVOR & FORTUNE

CHAPTER 18: PLANS, PEOPLE, AND PAPERWEIGHTS

I'VE PUT TOGETHER A FULL PROPOSAL. THREE SERVICE TIERS, TIME ESTIMATES, MATERIAL LISTS, AND A LOAD DIAGRAM FOR THE DUMBWAITER SHAFT.

SERVICE TIERS

BASIC

- Design + Materials
- Standard Load
- 5 Days

STANDARD

- Reinforced Build
- Safety Checks
- 7 Days

PREMIUM

- Counterweight Upgrade
- Custom Finishes
- 10 Days

All prices negotiable for Favor Partnerships.

TIME ESTIMATES

- Site Survey 1 Day
- Materials Prep 2 Days
- Construction 3-6 Days
- Testing & Tuning 1 Day
- Handover 1 Day

TOTAL (Standard): 7 Days

NOTES:
Weather, supply chain, and "unexpected discoveries" may adjust timeline.

DUMBWAITER SHAFT LOAD REQUIREMENTS

Max Load: 250 kg (551 lbs)
Safety Factor: x2
Design Load: 500 kg (1102 lbs)
Counterweight Ratio: 1.25:1
Sheave Dia: 240mm
Rope: 10mm Hemp Core
Guide Clearances: 15mm

IMPRESSIVE DETAIL, GRIP.

BUT TELL ME—WHICH PART OF THIS PROPOSAL DO YOU PERSONALLY STAND BEHIND?

STANDING BEHIND A PLAN IS NOT THE SAME AS BEING KNOWN BY THE PEOPLE INVOLVED.

THREE PAPERWEIGHTS. THREE FAILURES.

BRICK.

FWOOSH!

SMOOTH STONE.

WHOOSH!

BAG OF NAILS.

VWOOSH!

IS THE WIND PERSONALLY AGAINST ME?

YOU SAY THE PLATFORM SWINGS WHEN LOADED, RIGHT? ADD A SECOND GUIDE RAIL OPPOSITE THE FIRST—LIKE CLAMPING IT IN A TRACK.

DOUBLE THE GUIDANCE, HALF THE SWAY.

SIMPLE.

PRACTICAL WISDOM. MARKET-FRESH.

BOODLE FOUND GOOD THINGS!

SHARING MAKES EVERY PLAN BETTER!

HEE HEE!

INCH BY INCH.

MISSION: TABLE TAKEOVER.

SKITCH, WHAT ARE YOU DRAWING?

A UNIVERSAL CLARITY SYMBOL.

BEHOLD.

Max Load: 250 kg (551 lbs)
Safety Factor: x2
Design Load: 500 kg (1102 lbs)
Counterweight Ratio: 1.25:1

SEE? NOW ANYONE CAN UNDERSTAND AT A GLANCE.

IT'S SCIENCE.

THAT IS A CAT FACE.

IT DOES NOT CHANGE THE TENSILE STRENGTH OF ROPE.

IT IMPROVES READABILITY.

BETWEEN WIND, WISDOM, AND WHISKERS—PROGRESS IS STILL PROGRESS.



FIVE STRIPS
OF DRIED MEAT.

THREE.

FOUR.
FINAL.



THE MARKET
SPEAKS IN
MORE WAYS
THAN WORDS.



ATTENTION
GIVEN.



VOLUME
LOWERED.



SHADE
OFFERED.



EYES
MEET.



GRIP TRIES
TO CONTROL
THE TERMS.



BOODLE CREATES
GOODWILL WITHOUT
TRYING.



SKITCH TESTS
THE EDGES.



NONE FORCE.
ALL OFFER.

THIS IS
HOW A PLACE
REMAINS
IN BALANCE.



FOR YOU,
ELDER.



THANK YOU,
LITTLE ONE.



RESPECT IS THE CURRENCY THAT NEEDS
NO COIN.

THE WINDWARD ISLE

WHERE EVERY RULE
HAS A REASON.
AND EVERY REASON
HAS A STORY.

SO... WHY DO
YOU ROPE THE
ROOFTILES
DOWN?

BECAUSE THE
WIND HERE WILL
STEAL YOUR HAT,
YOUR SANDALS,
AND YOUR
DIGNITY.

NEXT?

AND THE
THREE BASINS?
FOR SPIRITS?
ANCESTORS?
BALANCE?

FOR WASHING,
RINSING,
AND NOT
MAKING A
MESS.
NEXT.

THE WIND
RITES? THE
KNOTS?
THE COLORS?

UTILITY.
IDENTITY.
AND SO WE DON'T
WAKE UP TO OUR
LAUNDRY IN THE
NEXT ISLAND.
NEXT?

EVERYTHING
HERE HAS A
STORY, AND
EVERY STORY
IS A RULE.

...AND HALF
THE RULES
ARE EXAGGER-
ATED NONSENSE.

WHICH
MAKES THE
GOOD ONES
SO MUCH
BETTER.

HEH.
FINALLY.
SOMEONE
WHO GETS IT.

AND THIS?
THE ELDER SAYS
WE NEVER OPEN
IT. NEVER.
NOT EVER.

WARNING
WHAT LIES BEYOND
IS NOT FOR
CURIOUS HANDS.
DISOBEDIENCE
BRINGS MISFORTUNE,
DISGRACE,
AND A VERY BAD DAY.
DO NOT OPEN.

OH, PLEASE.
IT'S PROBABLY
NOTHING.

IT'S JUST THE
CLEANING CLOSET.
BROOMS.
BUCKETS.
MOPS.
BORING STUFF.
REALLY.

...I MEAN IT.
REALLY.

...OKAY.
THAT IS
A LOT OF
BROOMS.
!!

TOLD YOU.

THE ELDER WAS
TECHNICALLY
RIGHT.

**A VERY BAD DAY
AWAITS ANYONE
WHO NEEDS EVEN
ONE OF THESE.**

ANCIENT RULES.
• ABSURD CONSEQUENCES.
BEST FRIENDS.



WHAT WE KEEP AND WHY



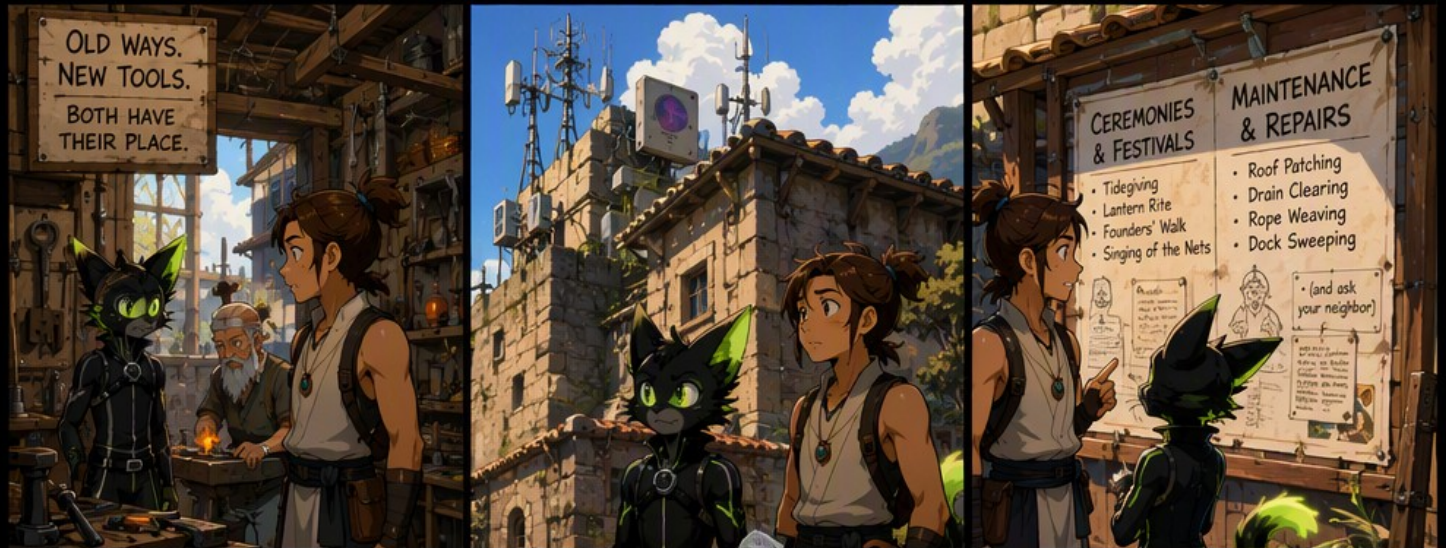
A WALK. A QUESTION.
A VERY LOUD ANSWER.



Some customs protect real knowledge.

Tides. Weather.
Star paths.

Things that
keep us alive.



OTHERS CONTINUE BECAUSE NOBODY WANTS TO BE THE FIRST TO STOP.



Then let's test
one. Right now.

They say this alley
amplifies dishonest
speech.

I will prove it
false!

I, SKITCH,
NEVER CAUSE
TROUBLE!



...So...
Was that the
alley...

...or just
clever stone
and shape?

Honestly?

I'm not sure.
And that might be
the smartest part.



KEEP WHAT HELPS. QUESTION THE REST. LISTEN CLOSELY.
TRADITION IS A TOOL—NOT A TRAP.

KESTREL ISLE
SOUTHERN REACH



...NO, NOT ON
THE COAST. YOU'D
HAVE TO GO INLAND.

PAST THE RIDGE, FOLLOW
THE RIVER FOR HALF A DAY.
THEN LOOK FOR THE SPLIT
BASALT FORMATION.

THAT'S AS
MUCH AS I CAN
SAY.

THE TONE OF A VOICE.
THE WAY INFORMATION
IS GIVEN—OR WITHHELD.
IT'S A MAP OF ITS OWN.



NOT
FOR SALE.

CONVERSATIONS
SHORTEN.



DISPLAYS
DISAPPEAR.



NOT SURE
WHAT YOU MEAN.

MAYBE ASK
SOMEONE ELSE.

ANSWERS GROW
VAGUE.



CAREFUL
INLAND.

SHARED CUPS ARE
NOT OFFERED.



OH! I
JUST REMEMBERED,
I NEED TO CHECK
MY NETS.

I'LL BE
BACK LATER!

PEOPLE SUDDENLY
REMEMBER OTHER
TASKS.



AFTER YOU,
ELDER.

THANK YOU,
YOUNG ONE.

NOT HOSTILITY.
JUST DISTANCE.

INFORMATION
IS A CURRENCY.
TRUST IS RARE.

AND WE DIDN'T
EARN EITHER—
NOT YET.



RESPECT OPENS DOORS.
GREED CLOSES MARKETS.



"IT WAS GENERATIONS AGO, WHEN THE VILLAGE STOOD WHERE THE CLIFF MEETS THE SEA.

"WE FACED A STORM THAT WOULD NOT BREAK, AND SO WE TOOK A ROPE..."

...AND EVERY HAND IN THE VILLAGE TOOK A STRAND.

WE BRAIDED IT TOGETHER— NOT BECAUSE THE ROPE WAS MAGIC...

...BUT BECAUSE WE WERE.

"SO WHEN THE WAVE CAME—HIGHER THAN ANY WE'D SEEN— THE ROPE HELD."



WOAH...

EVERYONE HELPED?



I SHOULD SLIP OUT— THERE'S SOMETHING I NEED TO CHECK.

OH NO YOU DON'T!
GRIP LOVES THIS PART OF THE STORY!

RIGHT, GRIP? ✨

TAP!



MORE ROASTED NUTS GOING AROUND!
TAKE SOME!



HMM.
THAT KNOT THERE... CLEVER WORK.



"WHUFF!"
...HERE COMES THE GOOD PART.



THAT DOESN'T MATCH WHAT I RECKONED...

BUT... IT EXPLAINS A FEW THINGS.

HMM.



AND THAT'S THE TRUTH, LITTLE ONES.

A ROPE IS ONLY AS STRONG AS THE HANDS THAT TWIST IT—AND THE HEARTS THAT HOLD IT.

REMEMBER THAT, AND THE STORM WILL NEVER BREAK YOU.

NOW... WHO'LL TELL THE NEXT PART WHEN I'M GONE?



THE OUTER EDGE
OF THE ISLAND.
THE FIRE IS DYING.

THE ROPE
NEGOTIATION.

THE ELDER'S
ATTENTION
TOWARD THE TRIO.

SKITCH AND THE
GRANDCHILD—
A GROWING
CONNECTION.

INTERESTING...
BUT NOT COINCIDENCE.
PATTERNS.

BOODLE SLEEPS,
UNAWARE.

